



LAST MONTH, METROPOLIS Healthcare Ltd said it was buying Agra-based Scientific Pathology Pvt Ltd to strengthen its presence in western Uttar Pradesh. Valued between ₹55 crore and ₹83 crore based on adjusted Ebita for a defined period, the deal will allow Metropolis to take over Scientific Pathology's laboratories and sample collection centres in the prosperous region.

76 | In April, Metropolis followed that up with the acquisition of Dr. Ahujas' Pathology and Imaging Centre, a diagnostics network based in Uttarakhand, for ₹35 crore in an all-cash deal. This was the third purchase in five months by Mumbai-based Metropolis Healthcare. In December 2024, it expanded its footprint in northern and eastern India by buying Gurugram-based Core Diagnostics for ₹246.8 crore, broadening its advanced care diagnostics portfolio.

Both Agra and Gurugram, a city in Haryana on the outskirts of New Delhi, are classified as Tier II cities, recognised for the lucrative business opportunities and relatively cost-effective operational base compared to metros like New Delhi and Mumbai.

According to the Healthcare Federation of India, over 50% of the so-called "aspirational districts" identified by the government think tank NITI Aayog are now being served by diagnostic

chains. Public-private partnerships (PPPs) have improved access to diagnostic services in Tier II and Tier III cities, it says.

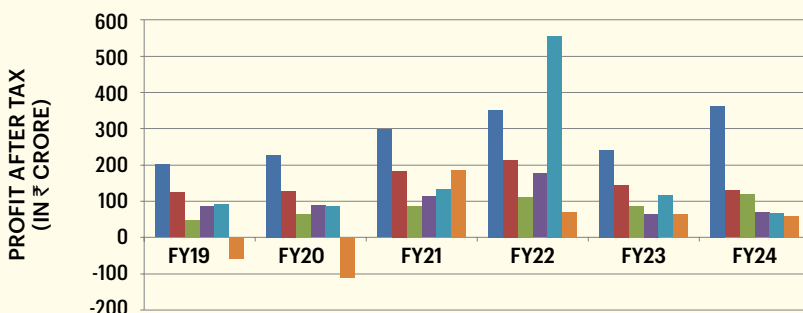
An upwardly mobile middle class that's propelling the rapid growth of small cities. Diagnostic

firms are expanding both organically and inorganically through mergers and acquisitions (M&As) in an industry that is expected to more than double in revenue between 2024 and 2030.

Companies like Dr Lal PathLabs

PROFIT PATH

● From FY19 to FY24, Dr Lal PathLabs led in profitability, except for FY22, when Agilus Diagnostics earned a profit of ₹550 crore



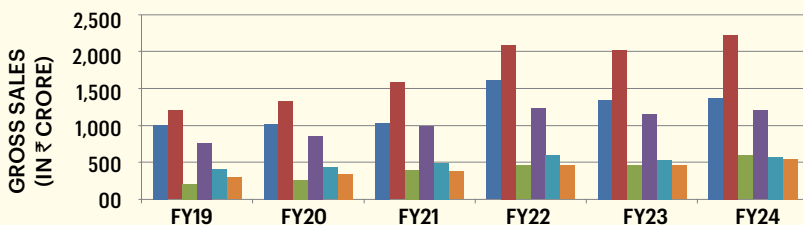
■ DR LAL PATHLABS LTD ■ METROPOLIS HEALTHCARE LTD
■ VIJAYA DIAGNOSTIC CENTRE LTD ■ THYROCARE TECHNOLOGIES LTD
■ AGILUS DIAGNOSTICS LTD ■ KRSNAA DIAGNOSTICS LTD

NOTE DATA ON A CONSOLIDATED BASIS

SOURCE ACE EQUITY

SALES PUSH

● Dr Lal Pathlabs led the pack even in terms of sales from FY19 to FY24, followed by Krsnaa Diagnostics and Agilus Diagnostics



■ AGILUS DIAGNOSTICS LTD ■ DR LAL PATHLABS LTD
■ KRSNAA DIAGNOSTICS LTD ■ METROPOLIS HEALTHCARE LTD
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